

- d) Whether they in fact exist, because you haven't actually met them. Your partner has left them repeated messages, saying he wants to introduce the three of you. But they won't return his calls. You can't help but wonder what he did to deserve the cold hard shoulder from his own flesh and blood.
- e) Why you haven't known them all your life. You've never met two nicer people, and they seem to have a very healthy relationship with their son. He's affectionate with them but not dependent, and the conversation flows freely, topics ranging from retirement planning to this year's hockey lineup. His parents' home is tasteful without being ostentatious, and it's clear where he got his good money sense.

3. You're planning your first vacation together. Your partner:

- a) Leaves all the organizing to you. He says it's not his strength, and that's true, but you suspect the real reason is that he's hoping you will pay for the plane fare and hotel reservations.
- b) Plans the most extravagant vacation you've ever heard of, barring celebrity weddings. A luxurious condo on the Kona Coast, five-course dinners every night—even a private masseuse. When you suggest a more frugal approach, he balks. "You deserve to be pampered," he says, but you're pretty sure it's his ego that's getting the pampering.
- c) Asks if you're cool going camping because he's got a pup tent and some firewood. You're actually up for the adventure—until he forgets to bring any food. You end up